

Lifeboat Services: All RNLI's Lifeboat Stations in Scotland — Service and Maintenance Agreement

"Effective Planning and Communication Supports Search and Rescue"

The Royal National Lifeboat Institution (RNLI) is a charity that saves lives at sea, providing, on call, a 24 hour search and rescue service around the UK and Ireland. RNLI Lifeboat volunteers launch in all sea conditions, covering the whole coastline, and in Scotland this includes the remote highlands and islands.

Customer requirements

When looking for a service partner for their lifeboat stations, RNLI sought a national partner with a proactive approach to maintenance. Coastal locations, with their combination of high winds and saltwater corrosion, are amongst the toughest environments for steel shutters and doors. Proactive maintenance is therefore an important tool for all lifeboat launch locations.



Key capabilities

Door breakdowns delay lifeboat launching and are therefore potentially life-threatening. The objective of the RNLI was to find and appoint a service partner who could:

- Demonstrate the ability to understand and pro-actively manage worn parts.
- Cover 28 lifeboat stations across Scotland, including highlands and islands.
- Offer a clear, organised service structure; an established organisation with fully trained and equipped engineers.
- Minimise the chance of a breakdown - lifeboats launch within 5 minutes of a request to launch , so doors must be ever ready.

Our service offer

ASSA ABLOY Entrance Systems worked with divisional and station managers to guarantee all core requirements. A service agreement was developed by ASSA ABLOY Entrance Systems maintenance specialists to deliver a solution for each station. A dedicated account manager for the region actively manages the relationship.

Visits to remote parts are planned in advance and ASSA ABLOY Entrance Systems engineers take a comprehensive stock of spare parts, facilitating a first time fix if corrective maintenance is required. A target of "zero callback" is the mutual goal.

As part of the agreement, a report is written for every visit and findings are presented in an easy to read format, designed specifically to the requirements of the RNLI.

Colin McNiven, Divisional Manager for RNLI Scotland comments

"While servicing and maintaining the RNLI's boathouse doors ASSA ABLOY Entrance Systems has provided a professional customer focused approach, ensuring our doors operate effectively and safely along with providing value for money. A key element in this service is the provision of quality engineers and good management support."



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